Staff answers & diagnostic guide — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: What is the biggest danger of adding lots of random extra marks all over a finished artwork without a plan?

Correct: Overworking the piece until the contrast turns muddy and the focal point disappears — Exactly. One named, surgical refinement beats random overworking every time.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: When must you fill in the 'What I will change and why' box on your refinement card? -> Before you touch the artwork with any pen, brush, or pastel (Yes! Naming the change first makes your refinement 100% intentional.)

Q2: If your central motif looks flat against the background, which refinement gives the fastest boost? -> Deepening the dark shadow edge on one side and adding a crisp highlight rim on the opposite side (Correct. Pushing both ends of the tonal scale creates instant 3D presence.)

Q3: How do you know when your targeted refinement is finished? -> As soon as the specific problem you named on

your card is solved when viewed from two paces back (Spot on. Step back, verify the fix works, and put the tool down.)

Exit check answer

Question: Why do we stop working as soon as our one or two named refinements are complete?

Correct: To keep the artwork fresh and high-contrast without overworking or muddying the surface — Correct. Deliberate restraint protects the clarity of your work.